Strategy

Project Summary

GamePriceCheck is an application designed to help gamers and collectors find and compare prices for physical video games, gaming consoles, and gaming accessories. The purpose of the system is to provide users with one convenient place to search for gaming products and view pricing information from multiple retailers and sellers instead of having to visit several different websites individually. The application will focus on physical gaming products rather than digital downloads and will not directly sell products or process transactions.

Based on the client interview, the first version of GamePriceCheck will focus primarily on providing a simple and efficient product search and price comparison experience. Users will be able to enter the name of a video game, console, or accessory and view relevant products from different retailers and sellers. Searches may also use information such as the developer, release year, and product condition. Search results will display useful information such as a product image, seller or retailer, price, condition, and seller or website reliability. Users will also be able to filter results based on factors (condition, developer, price, and discount amount).

For products available from multiple sellers, such as products listed on eBay, the application will help users distinguish between listings based on factors such as product condition and seller reliability. Once users identify a product they are interested in, GamePriceCheck will direct them to the retailer or seller's website to complete the purchase. GamePriceCheck itself will not collect payments, process transactions, or provide shipping services.

The original Baseline Plan included additional features such as user accounts, saved products, price-history charts, target prices, and price alerts. However, the client interview clarified that the initial version should prioritize the application's core search and comparison functionality. Notifications and user profiles are not necessary for the first version and may instead be considered for future development.

User Constituencies

The primary users of GamePriceCheck will be gamers and video game collectors who are interested in finding physical copies of games, consoles, and accessories at competitive prices. These users may range from casual gamers looking for a specific

game or console to more experienced gamers and collectors searching for older, preowned, or discounted products.

Users may have different levels of knowledge about video games and online shopping. Because the client wants the application to also be usable by people with limited video game experience, the interface should remain simple and provide clear categories and filters. Users should not need extensive gaming knowledge to successfully search for a product.

The primary goal of these users is to quickly determine where a gaming product is available and which retailer or seller provides the best option. Users need an efficient way to compare prices, conditions, discounts, and seller reliability without manually searching multiple websites. They also need clear product information that allows them to make an informed decision before being redirected to the seller's website.

A secondary user group may include collectors and more experienced gaming enthusiasts. These users may be particularly interested in older physical games, specific developers or release years, preowned products, and differences in product condition. More detailed filters will help these users narrow their searches to products that meet their specific preferences.

Usage Contexts

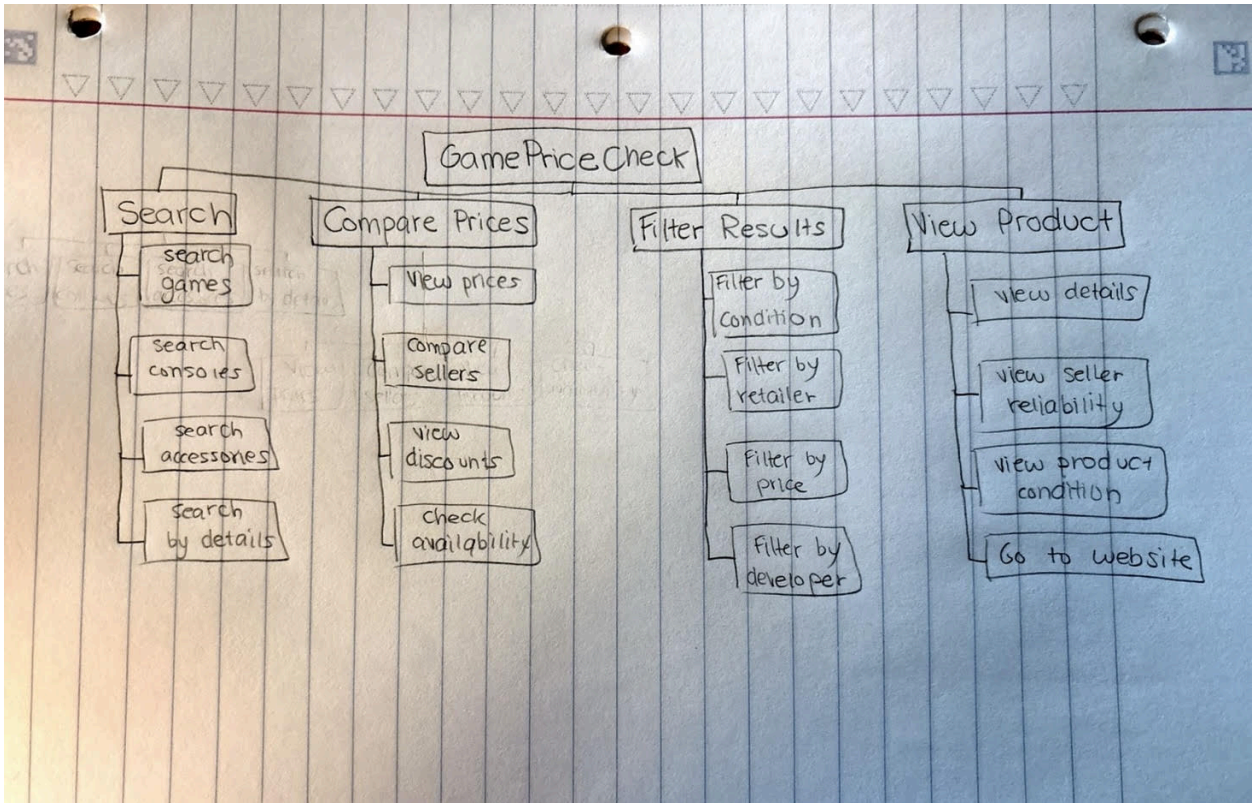
GamePriceCheck will primarily be used as an online application accessible through desktop and mobile devices. Users may access the system from home, school, work, or other locations when they want to research the price and availability of a gaming product. The interface should therefore be responsive and easy to navigate on different screen sizes.

A typical user may open GamePriceCheck, use the search bar to enter the game, console, or accessory they are looking for, and then review results from different retailers or sellers. The user can narrow the results using categories and filters and compare available prices before selecting a listing. The system will then redirect the user to the appropriate retailer or seller to view or purchase the product.

Because GamePriceCheck relies on current product listings and pricing information from online retailers and sellers, an internet connection will be required to use its main features. The system should assume that most users are accessing it from a personal computer, tablet, or smartphone with a standard internet connection. Users may access the system from shared devices, particularly in school or work environments, so basic searches should not require users to create an account or provide personal information.

For the initial version, users should be able to access the application's main search and comparison features without logging in. If account-based features such as saving products or receiving alerts are added in a future version, users would need to log in before accessing those personalized features.

Scope



<u>User Stories</u>

1. Search for Games
   As a gamer, I want to search for a video game by name so that I can quickly find available copies of the game I want.
2. Search for Consoles
   As a gamer, I want to search for a gaming console by name so that I can find available consoles from different sellers.

3. Search for Accessories
   As a gamer, I want to search for gaming accessories so that I can find accessories that meet my gaming needs.
4. View Product Prices
   As a gamer, I want to view the prices of a product from different sellers so that I can determine how much the product costs at each seller.
5. As a price-conscious gamer, I want to compare multiple sellers offering the same product so that I can choose the seller that provides the best option.
6. As a gamer, I want to see whether a product is currently available from a seller so that I do not waste time visiting a listing for an unavailable product.
7. As a gamer, I want to filter products by condition so that I only see products that are new, used, or refurbished based on my preference.
8. As a price-conscious gamer, I want to filter search results by price so that I only see products within my budget.
9. As a gamer, I want to view detailed information about a product so that I can determine whether it is the product I am looking for.
10. As a gamer, I want to select a product listing and be redirected to the seller's website so that I can complete my purchase directly through the seller.